

NATURE OF RELIGIOUS LANGUAGE

OFFICIAL BOUNDARY AND THE → AQUINAS AND SCOTUS: CONTINUITY → TILlich: SYMBOL, PARTICIPATION AND → VERIFICATION, FALSIFICATION AND THE → BRAITHWAITE AND QUALIFIED WITTGENSTEINIAN → SPEECH ACTS, RAMSEY AND

Read the numbered rail in order. Every syllabus and PYQ-essential distinction is Core; the final grey node is genuinely optional enrichment.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • g12 • fresh deep review required • prior artefacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 OFFICIAL BOUNDARY AND THE TWO-AXIS CONTROL

OFFICIAL BOUNDARY AND THE TWO-AXIS CONTROL GENERATED 2026-08-27 APPROVAL FALSE OFFICIAL CLAUSE ANALOGICAL AND SYMBOLIC; COGNITIVIST AND NON-COGNITIVE HOW DOES A PREDICATE REFER? DOES THE UTTERANCE STATE A TRUTH?

"GOD IS GOOD" MAY BE ANALOGICAL AND COGNITIVE AT

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- IDENTITY → learner-v2:g12
- generated 2026-08-27
- approval FALSE

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- OFFICIAL CLAUSE → analogical and symbolic; cognitivist and non-cognitive
- HOW DOES A PREDICATE REFER?
- DOES THE UTTERANCE STATE A TRUTH?

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CONTROL → "God is good" may be ANALOGICAL and COGNITIVE at once.
- Never infer truth-status from semantic mode or semantic mode from use.

STAGE 01 AQUINAS AND SCOTUS: CONTINUITY WITHOUT COLLAPSE

AQUINAS AND SCOTUS CONTINUITY WITHOUT COLLAPSE PURE PERFECTION EXISTS IN GOD ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY RES PERFECTION SIGNIFIED APPLIES TRULY TO GOD MODUS SIGNIFICANDI CREATURE-DERIVED MANNER REMAINS INADEQUATE AQUINAS REJECTS

"GOD IS GOOD" MERELY MEANS GOD CAUSES GOODNESS LATER ATTRIBUTION AND PROPORTIONALITY SYSTEMATISATION

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
AQUINAS → pure perfection exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY res significata = perfection signified applies truly to systematisation	Aquinas REJECTS: "God is good" merely means God causes goodness later Thomist/Cajetan: attribution and proportionality systematisation	TRADE-OFF → univocity risks anthropomorphism; analogy risks indeterminacy.
God modus significandi = creature-derived manner remains inadequate	SCOTUS → semantic, NOT ontological, univocity secures valid inference one common concept; FINITE / INFINITE INTRINSIC MODES preserve the gulf	AQUINAS → pure perfection exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY res significata = perfection signified applies truly to
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE - AQUINAS → pure perfection exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY res significata = perfection signified applies truly to - God modus significandi = creature-derived manner remains inadequate	DECISIVE DISTINCTION - Aquinas REJECTS: "God is good" merely means God causes goodness later Thomist/Cajetan: attribution and proportionality systematisation - SCOTUS → semantic, NOT ontological, univocity secures valid inference one common concept; FINITE / INFINITE INTRINSIC MODES preserve the gulf	EVALUATION / TRAP - TRADE-OFF → univocity risks anthropomorphism; analogy risks indeterminacy. - AQUINAS → pure perfection exists in God ESSENTIALLY AND EMINENTLY res significata = perfection signified applies truly to

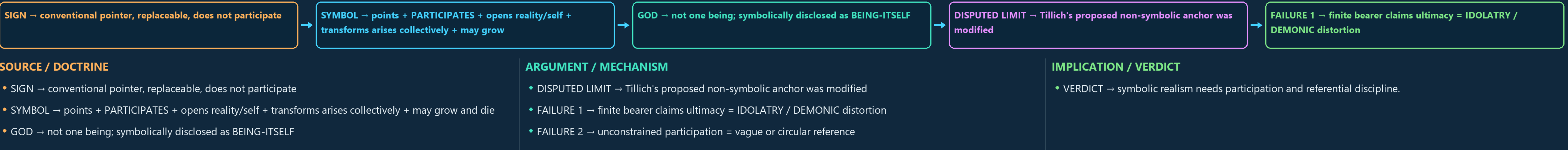
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRADE-OFF → univocity risks anthropomorphism; analogy risks indeterminacy.

02

STAGE 02 TILlich: SYMBOL, PARTICIPATION AND DISTORTION

SYMBOL, PARTICIPATION AND DISTORTION CONVENTIONAL POINTER, REPLACEABLE, DOES NOT PARTICIPATE POINTS + PARTICIPATES + OPENS REALITY/SELF + TRANSFORMS ARISES NOT ONE BEING; SYMBOLICALLY DISCLOSED AS BEING-ITSELF DISPUTED LIMIT

TILlich'S PROPOSED NON-SYMBOLIC ANCHOR WAS MODIFIED FAILURE 1 FINITE BEARER CLAIMS ULTIMACY



SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- SIGN → conventional pointer, replaceable, does not participate
- SYMBOL → points + PARTICIPATES + opens reality/self + transforms arises collectively + may grow and die
- GOD → not one being; symbolically disclosed as BEING-ITSELF

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- DISPUTED LIMIT → Tillich's proposed non-symbolic anchor was modified
- FAILURE 1 → finite bearer claims ultimacy = IDOLATRY / DEMONIC distortion
- FAILURE 2 → unconstrained participation = vague or circular reference

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → symbolic realism needs participation and referential discipline.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → symbolic realism needs participation and referential discipline.

03

STAGE 03 VERIFICATION, FALSIFICATION AND THE COGNITIVE SPECTRUM

VERIFICATION, FALSIFICATION AND THE COGNITIVE SPECTRUM COGNITIVE REALISM CLAIMS MAY BE TRUE OR FALSE; ANALOGY CAN QUALIFY UNVERIFIABLE THEOLOGY IS LITERALLY MEANINGLESS WHAT COULD COUNT AGAINST IT? DEATH BY A THOUSAND

NON-FACTUAL WORLD-ORIENTATION CAN STILL GOVERN LIFE TRUTH-APT DEFEASIBLE TRUST ADMITS ADVERSE EVIDENCE ESCHATOLOGICAL VERIFICATION

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
- COGNITIVE REALISM → claims may be true or false; analogy can qualify mode - AYER → unverifiable theology is literally meaningless - FLEW → what could count against it? death by a thousand qualifications	- HARE → blink: non-factual world-orientation can still govern life - MITCHELL → partisan: truth-apt DEFEASIBLE TRUST admits adverse evidence - HICK → eschatological verification: confirmable at the journey's end	- BRAITHWAITE → moral commitment; constructive, not Ayer's elimination - CONTROL → unverifiability is not automatically a formal contradiction.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL → unverifiability is not automatically a formal contradiction.

04

STAGE 04 BRAITHWAITE AND QUALIFIED WITTGENSTEINIAN USE

BRAITHWAITE AND QUALIFIED WITTGENSTEINIAN USE "GOD IS LOVE" AVOWS AN AGAPEISTIC MORAL POLICY STORIES CONDUCT; RISK WITTGENSTEIN'S LECTURES LAST JUDGEMENT DIFFERS FROM ORDINARY PREDICTION LATER WITTGENSTEINIANS LANGUAGE-GAME, GRAMMAR AND FORM OF LIFE

D. Z. PHILLIPS

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
- BRAITHWAITE → "God is love" avows an AGAPEISTIC MORAL POLICY stories sustain intention; strength = conduct; risk = reductionism - WITTGENSTEIN'S LECTURES → Last Judgement differs from ordinary prediction - LATER WITTGENSTEINIANS → language-game, grammar and form of life	D. Z. PHILLIPS → resisted reductionist/simple non-cognitivist labels - OBJECTION → internal grammar can become fideistic insulation - REPLY → use explains intelligibility, not automatic truth or immunity	VERDICT → practical force may supplement rather than erase assertion.

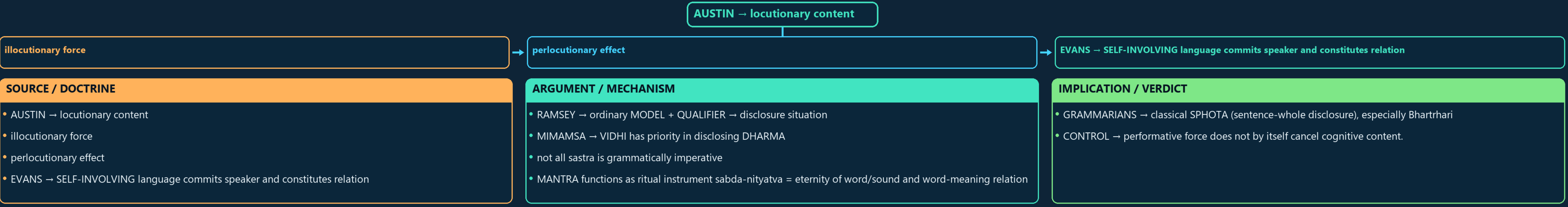
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → practical force may supplement rather than erase assertion.

05

STAGE 05 SPEECH ACTS, RAMSEY AND MIMAMSA

SPEECH ACTS, RAMSEY AND MIMAMSA LOCUTIONARY CONTENT ILLOCUTIONARY FORCE PERLOCUTIONARY EFFECT SELF-INVOLVING LANGUAGE COMMITTS SPEAKER AND CONSTITUTES RELATION ORDINARY MODEL + QUALIFIER DISCLOSURE SITUATION

VIDHI HAS PRIORITY IN DISCLOSING DHARMA; NOT ALI SASTRA



SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- AUSTIN → locutionary content
- illocutionary force
- perlocutionary effect
- EVANS → SELF-INVOLVING language commits speaker and constitutes relation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- RAMSEY → ordinary MODEL + QUALIFIER → disclosure situation
- MIMAMSA → VIDHI has priority in disclosing DHARMA
- not all sastra is grammatically imperative
- MANTRA functions as ritual instrument sabda-nyatva = eternity of word/sound and word-meaning relation

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- GRAMMARIANS → classical SPHOTA (sentence-whole disclosure), especially Bharthari
- CONTROL → performative force does not by itself cancel cognitive content.

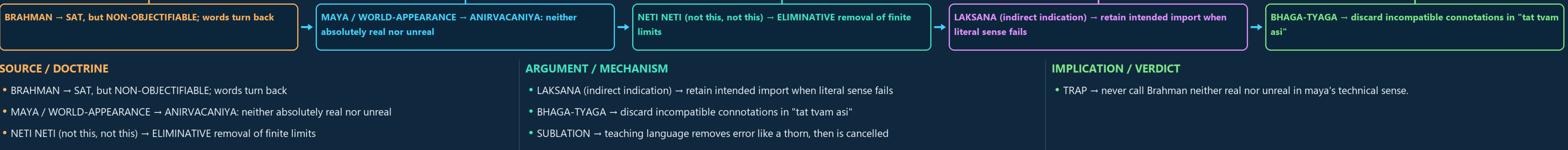
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL → performative force does not by itself cancel cognitive content.

06

STAGE 06 ADVAITA: NEGATION, INDICATION AND SUBLATION

NEGATION, INDICATION AND SUBLATION SAT, BUT NON-OBJECTIFIABLE; WORDS TURN BACK NEITHER ABSOLUTELY REAL NOR UNREAL NETI NETI (NOT THIS, NOT THAT) ELIMINATIVE REMOVAL OF FINITE LIMITS LAKSANA (INDIRECT INDICATION) RETAIN INTENDED IMPORT WHEN LITERAL SENSE FAILS

DISCARD INCOMPATIBLE CONNOTATIONS IN "TAT TVAM ASI"



SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- BRAHMAN → SAT, but NON-OBJECTIFIABLE; words turn back
- MAYA / WORLD-APPEARANCE → ANIRVACANIYA: neither absolutely real nor unreal
- NETI NETI (not this, not that) → ELIMINATIVE removal of finite limits

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- LAKSANA (indirect indication) → retain intended import when literal sense fails
- BHAGA-TYAGA → discard incompatible connotations in "tat tvam asi"
- SUBLATION → teaching language removes error like a thorn, then is cancelled

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

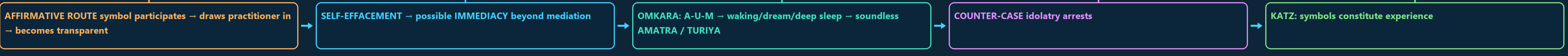
- TRAP → never call Brahman neither real nor unreal in maya's technical sense.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → never call Brahman neither real nor unreal in maya's technical sense.

07

STAGE 07 FROM SYMBOL TOWARD MYSTICISM: MECHANISM AND COUNTER-CASE

FROM SYMBOL TOWARD MYSTICISM MECHANISM AND COUNTER-CASE AFFIRMATIVE ROUTE SYMBOL PARTICIPATES DRAWS PRACTITIONER IN BECOMES TRANSPARENT POSSIBLE IMMEDIACY BEYOND MEDIATION WAKING/DREAM/DEEP SLEEP SOUNDLESS AMATRA



SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- AFFIRMATIVE ROUTE symbol participates → draws practitioner in → becomes transparent
- SELF-EFFACEMENT → possible IMMEDIACY beyond mediation
- OMKARA: A-U-M → waking/dream/deep sleep → soundless AMATRA / TURIYA

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- COUNTER-CASE idolatry arrests
- KATZ: symbols constitute experience
- iconoclasm deletes ethics, inquiry and grace show NON-NECESSITY; no symbol guarantees mysticism

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- VERDICT → normal and powerful route, but neither necessary nor sufficient.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → normal and powerful route, but neither necessary nor sufficient.

08

STAGE 08 FOURTEEN VERIFIED PYQ DEMAND ROUTES

FOURTEEN VERIFIED PYQ DEMAND ROUTES 2018 Q5(A) SECULAR/RELIGIOUS USE Q7(B) BRAITHWAITE Q8(C) SYMBOL MEDIATION 2019 Q6(A) WHETHER AND HOW SYMBOL LEADS TO MYSTICISM 2020 Q8(A) COGNITIVE CONTENT IN DETAIL 2021 Q8(A) BRAITHWAITE NON-COGNITIVE

Q8(C) TILlich SYMBOLISM

SOURCE / DOCTRINE	ARGUMENT / MECHANISM	IMPLICATION / VERDICT
2018 Q5(a) secular/religious use - Q7(b) Braithwaite - Q8(c) symbol mediation 2019 Q6(a) whether AND how symbol leads to mysticism 2020 Q8(a) cognitive content in detail	2021 Q8(a) Braithwaite non-cognitive - Q8(c) Tillich symbolism 2022 Q5(e) "God exists": cognitive versus non-cognitive 2023 Q5(d) qualified Wittgenstein - Q7(c) Tillich	2024 Q5(e) analogy - Q8(a) cognitive/non-cognitive plus contradiction 10+10 2025 Q5(b) symbolic? reasons - Q8(c) Advaitic anirvacanyata - CONTROL → obey directive, printed marks split and answer-specific mechanism.

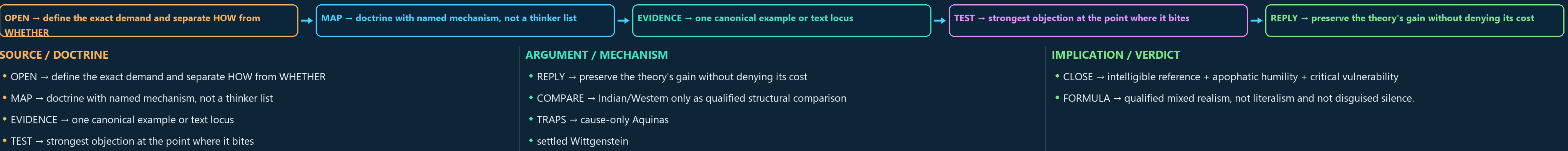
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL → obey directive, printed marks split and answer-specific mechanism.

09

STAGE 09 EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE, TRAPS AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION

EXECUTABLE ANSWER SPINE, TRAPS AND QUALIFIED CONCLUSION DEFINE THE EXACT DEMAND AND SEPARATE HOW FROM WHETHER DOCTRINE WITH NAMED MECHANISM, NOT A THINKER LIST ONE CANONICAL EXAMPLE OR TEXT LOCUS STRONGEST OBJECTION AT THE POINT WHERE IT BITES

PRESERVE THE THEORY'S GAIN WITHOUT DENYING ITS COST INDIAN/WESTERN ONLY AS QUALIFIED STRUCTURAL COMPARISON CAUSE-ONLY AQUINAS



SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- OPEN → define the exact demand and separate HOW from WHETHER
- MAP → doctrine with named mechanism, not a thinker list
- EVIDENCE → one canonical example or text locus
- TEST → strongest objection at the point where it bites

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- REPLY → preserve the theory's gain without denying its cost
- COMPARE → Indian/Western only as qualified structural comparison
- TRAPS → cause-only Aquinas
- settled Wittgenstein

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- CLOSE → intelligible reference + apophatic humility + critical vulnerability
- FORMULA → qualified mixed realism, not literalism and not disguised silence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FORMULA → qualified mixed realism, not literalism and not disguised silence.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT RADICAL ORTHODOXY AND THE GENEALOGY OF UNIVOCITY FICTIONALISM AND RELIGIOUS MAKE-BELIEVE SPECIALIST METAPHOR DEBATES PLURALISM BRIDGE RADICAL ORTHODOXY AND THE GENEALOGY OF UNIVOCITY SOME RADICAL

THIS IS A CONTESTED HISTORICAL THESIS, NOT THE CORE USE IT ONLY AS ONE OPTIONAL HISTORIOGRAPHIC CRITICISM AFTER

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- Radical Orthodoxy and the genealogy of univocity - Fictionalism and religious make-believe - Specialist metaphor debates - Pluralism bridge	- Radical Orthodoxy and the genealogy of univocity Some Radical Orthodoxy readings connect Scotist univocity to later secular metaphysics. - This is a contested historical thesis, not the Core meaning of Scotus's semantic univocity. - Use it only as one optional historiographic criticism after accurately stating intrinsic finite/infinite modes. - Fictionalism and religious make-believe Religious fictionalism treats theological narratives as practically or imaginatively useful without belief in their	- literal truth. - it differs from Braithwaite's moral-conative account, Hare's blik, error theory and ordinary symbolic realism. - It is enrichment rather than a required answer to the official clause. - Specialist metaphor debates Metaphor theories ask whether religious predicates create redescriptions rather than track an ordered metaphysical similarity.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.